

BIRKEN LAKESIDE RESORT • SINCE 1906

WHAT TO EXPECT. WHAT TO BRING.

Woodsmoke. Pristine water. Good people.

A GUEST GUIDE FOR YOUR STAY
2026 SEASON

A NOTE BEFORE THE DRIVE

YOU'RE COMING TO BIRKEN.

We've been here since 1906 — same stretch of Gates Lake, same red-cedar cabins, same view across the water. Some things have changed; the place itself, not so much. This guide is to help you arrive ready, settle in fast, and spend less of your weekend wondering where the corkscrew is.

Read it once before you pack. Keep it on your phone for the drive.

THE SHORTEST VERSION

Bring layers. Bring groceries. Download offline maps before you leave Pemberton. Your cabin has linens, towels, and a full or partial kitchen — bring the food, the bug spray, and the sense of humour. The lake is cold and the stars are loud. That's the whole brief.

01 • GETTING HERE

THE DRIVE IS PART OF IT.

Birken sits at the northern end of the Sea-to-Sky corridor, about 25 minutes past Pemberton on Highway 99. The drive from Vancouver is one of the most scenic in Canada — Howe Sound, Tantalus Range, Pemberton Valley, then the road softens and the cabins appear in the trees.

Approximate drive times

FROM VANCOUVER	2 hours 30 minutes
FROM WHISTLER	55 minutes
FROM PEMBERTON	25 minutes
FROM VANCOUVER AIRPORT (YVR)	3 hours

Before you leave Pemberton

Pemberton is your last stop for full cell coverage, full grocery, and full fuel. Two practical things to do before the final 25-minute push:

- **Download offline maps.** Cell service is spotty once you're north of Pemberton. Google Maps offline or onX both work — set it up before you lose signal.
- **Top up groceries.** Pemberton Valley Supermarket and Mile One Market are both on the way through. Our General Store has the essentials, but not a week's worth of meals.
- **Fill the tank.** The Petro-Canada in Pemberton is your last reliable fuel stop.

The final stretch

The last few minutes are quiet road through forest. Watch for deer at dusk, and slow down — the wildlife here doesn't expect traffic. Our driveway is on the lake side of the highway, marked with the Birken Lakeside Resort sign. Pull in, park where you'd like, and come find us at the office or General Store to check in.

If you're arriving after 8:00 PM, give us a call — we'll have your cabin key in an envelope at the office door.

CHECK-IN & CHECK-OUT

Check-in: 4:00 PM. Check-out: 11:00 AM. Need to drop bags earlier or stay a little longer? Just ask. We can sometimes make it work.

02 • WHAT'S IN YOUR CABIN

ALREADY THERE, READY TO USE.

Every cabin is its own character — the Morocco is small and rustic, the Bunk House is built for a crew, the Chapel has cathedral ceilings and the only private washroom on property. But across the board, here's what we've already taken care of:

In every cabin

- Bed linens and pillows, made up before you arrive.
- Bath towels and a couple of hand towels.
- Basic kitchen kit — dishes, glassware, mugs, cutlery, pots, pans, kettle, coffee maker, basic utensils.
- Dish soap, hand soap, a small starter kit of paper towels.
- Heating — wood stove, fireplace, or electric, depending on the cabin.
- Solid Wi-Fi (it works — just spare us the 4K streaming).

Kitchen specifics — varies by cabin

- Full kitchens: Love Shack, Library, Mexico, Bunk House, Wild West, Chapel.
- Kitchenette (bar fridge, stove, oven, coffee maker): Morocco.
- Glamping tents: shared communal outdoor kitchen with BBQ and prep area.

Washrooms

One cabin — the Chapel — has its own private washroom. Every other cabin shares the central heated facility a short walk away. It's clean, bright, and stocked with hot water, stone-floor showers, and a men's and women's section. Bring a small toiletry kit you don't mind carrying back and forth.

Heating & firewood

Cabins with wood stoves or fireplaces are stocked with kindling and a starter supply. Additional firewood crates are \$18 each from the General Store — for indoor use only, and one crate usually does a cosy evening. Bring an extra long-sleeve layer; the cabins warm up fast but the mornings are mountain-cool even in July.

03 • WHAT TO BRING

PACK LIKE YOU'RE GOING TO A FRIEND'S CABIN.

That's the right mental model. You're not packing for a hotel — you're packing for a place that has what you need to live and the things that make it feel like home, but where you'll cook your own breakfast and tend your own fire. The list below is the working version. Adapt it to who you are.

WHAT WE PROVIDE

- Bed linens, pillows, towels
- Cookware, dishes, glassware, cutlery
- Coffee maker, kettle, basic utensils
- Dish soap, hand soap, paper towel starter
- Firewood starter kit (cabins with stoves)
- Wi-Fi across the property
- Lake access, dock, sports cupboard
- BBQs (gas — propane available to rent)

WHAT TO BRING

- Groceries & cooler for the drive
- Coffee, tea, salt, pepper, basic pantry
- Bug spray (it earns its keep)
- Sunscreen, sun hat, lip balm
- Swimsuit & quick-dry towel
- Warm layer + rain layer (always)
- Sturdy shoes — terrain is uneven
- Headlamp or flashlight
- Bottle opener, corkscrew, cookware extras
- A book. A real one.

The bring-if-you-have-it list

Not essential, but they make the place sing:

- Bluetooth speaker (for daytime — quiet hours are 10 PM to 8 AM).
- Camp chairs or beach blanket for the dock.
- Binoculars — the ospreys and loons are right there.
- Fishing rod (Gates Lake has rainbow and cutthroat trout up to 6 lbs — BC fishing licence required).
- Paddleboard or kayak if you have one (rentals are on the roadmap for 2026; not all add-ons live yet).
- A board game. The kind of weekend it is.

- Marshmallows, hot dogs, the things a fire is for.

If you're bringing your dog

Birken is PAW Pet Friendly. Dogs are part of the brand. Pack:

- Leash (required everywhere on the property).
- Their bowl, bed, and food.
- Towel for the inevitable lake swim.
- Poo bags. The \$15/night pet fee covers cleaning — it doesn't cover the trail.

Note: dogs aren't permitted on the beach or inside the Grille, General Store, Meeting Hall, or central washroom. Cabins and the rest of the property are theirs.

04 • SEASON & WEATHER

PACK FOR THE MOUNTAINS, NOT THE CITY.

We sit in a transition zone — drier and hotter than Whistler in summer, with bigger temperature swings between day and night. The rule we tell every guest: bring one more layer than you think you need.

Spring (May – mid-June)

Cool mornings, warmer afternoons, real chance of rain. Snowmelt makes the waterfalls spectacular. Pack: warm layer, rain shell, hiking shoes, swimsuit (optimistic but possible).

Summer (mid-June – early September)

Hot, dry days. Cool nights. Long evenings on the dock. Bug levels peak in early summer — bring repellent. Pack: swimsuit, sandals, a hat, sunscreen, light layers, and one warm thing for after sunset.

Fall (mid-September – October)

Shoulder-season sweet spot. Cool, clear, fewer people. The larches turn gold. Pack: warm layers, rain shell, hiking shoes, a wool sweater for the porch.

Wildfire season — be informed

BC summers come with wildfire risk. We post current fire bans at the General Store and the Meeting Hall noticeboard, and we'll flag any impacts to your stay before arrival. Check the BC Wildfire Service app before you head up so you arrive with current information.

05 • ON THE PROPERTY

WHAT'S OPEN, WHEN.

The Birken Lakeside Grille

Gourmet comfort food from local chefs, served from the deck where the lake meets the dock. Open weekends only, seasonal. Check our updates email or ask at the office for current hours — they shift with the season. Reservations recommended for dinner.

The General Store

Open daily. Firewood crates (\$18), pantry essentials, local treats, artisan gifts, and the things you didn't know you forgot. Also where you'll find current fire-ban notices and area updates.

The waterfront

Private dock access, designated swimming area, and a small sports cupboard (basketball, badminton, volleyball, bocce) you're welcome to use. Lifejackets are not provided — bring your own for kids or for paddling.

The fire pits

Communal fire pits around the property — first come, first served when fire bans permit. Some cabins have their own private firepit area too. Indoor firewood is for the wood stove only; outdoor fire pits run on the supply already at each ring.

06 • THINGS WORTH KNOWING

QUICK REMINDERS.

These all live in your booking confirmation under the full Terms & Conditions, but they're worth keeping in front of you:

- **Quiet hours:** 10:00 PM to 8:00 AM. Sound carries across water — what feels conversational on your porch lands clearly on the cabin opposite.
- **Smoking & cannabis:** Outdoor designated areas only. Never inside cabins or on porches. Wildfire country, hundred-year-old wood.
- **No candles, incense, or open flames inside cabins.** No fireworks anywhere on the property. Battery-operated candles are welcome.
- **Food storage:** Inside cabins. Never on porches or in coolers outside. Bears are real.
- **Pets leashed everywhere on the property.** Not on the beach. Not in common buildings.
- **Mountain Wi-Fi.** It works. Use it sparingly. The lake is the better view.

THE AREA AROUND US.

You don't have to leave the property for the weekend to feel full. But if you do, here's the quick orientation. We have a fuller Local Guide at the office — ask for a copy when you check in.

The big three nearby

- **Birkenhead Lake Provincial Park (20 min).** Old-growth forest, sandy beaches, easy walking trails. The local favourite.
- **Joffre Lakes Provincial Park (30 min).** Three glacier-fed turquoise lakes. Stunning but busy — a day-use pass is required in 2026 and must be booked in advance through BC Parks.
- **Pemberton (25 min south).** Mountain biking capital, farm-to-table eateries, the Friday farmers' market (May to October, 3–6 PM at the Downtown Barn).

Three places worth the drive

- Mile One Eating House — the post-hike burger, Pemberton.
- Blackbird Bakery — get there before 10 AM or the croissants are gone.
- North Arm Farm — u-pick berries in summer, pumpkins in fall, local honey year-round.

QUESTIONS BEFORE YOU ARRIVE?

WE'RE HERE.

If anything in this guide raises a question — about your cabin, the drive, the weather, what to do with the kids on a rainy afternoon — just ask. The fastest way to reach us is email, or the phone if it's urgent.

PHONE	(604) 452-3255
EMAIL	hello@birkenlakesideresort.ca
WEB	birkenlakesideresort.ca

See you at the dock.

BIRKEN LAKESIDE RESORT • SINCE 1906 • GATES LAKE, BC